

Truly Madly **TM** Café

From Dating Feature to India's Loneliness Economy Marketplace

A Capstone Case Study by **Lakshit Jain** · Cohort 28

Step 1

Market & User Research

Step 2

Frame the Problem

Step 3

Solution Ideation & Prioritisation

Step 4

Design & Prototype

Step 5

GTM & Monetisation

Steps 6–8

Metrics, Risks & AI

The Core Problem

TM Café is under-discovered and poorly integrated into the user journey, failing to capture users at high-intent emotional moments — leading to low activation and monetisation despite strong demand for emotional support.

Research Objective

- Who pays for emotional support and dating advice in India
- Why users choose paid platforms over friends
- When users are most likely to seek help (trigger moments)
- What would make TM Café their first choice

The Opportunity

TrulyMadly has **12 million users** who experience the exact emotional moments TM Café is designed for. Astrotalk has proven Indian users will pay — **₹1,600 Cr in annual revenue** and 1.5 million transacting users.

The product just needs to show up at the right moment, remove the payment barrier, and deliver real value in the first 2 minutes.

How the Research Was Done

Method	What Was Done	Type	Key Output
Personal App Testing	Uploaded a fake female photo — accepted without any verification check	Primary	Verification gap confirmed
Play Store Review Analysis	Screenshotted multiple pages of TrulyMadly & Astrotalk reviews (Feb–Apr 2026)	Secondary	4 pain patterns: fake profiles, charges, paywalls, spam
Google Form Survey	Distributed survey on user emotions, trigger moments, willingness to pay	Primary	Quantitative data on trigger moments & pricing preferences
User Interviews	Friends (age 22–26, Bengaluru) on dating app experiences & Astrotalk payments	Primary	Validated freemium conversion — friends paid after 2 mins free
Competitive Benchmarking	Used Astrotalk & YourDost; compared UI, pricing, conversion model	Secondary	Astrotalk freemium model identified as benchmark
In-App Analysis	Navigated TM app, counted clicks to Café, tested payment flow	Primary	Café buried 3–4 clicks deep; no moment-match nudge exists

Why Do Users Call TrulyMadly a Scam?

The Trust Problem is a Product Failure

TrulyMadly markets a **90% profile verification promise**. In practice, a fake female photo sourced from the internet was accepted without any check, flag, or rejection on April 25, 2026.

Real users are being matched with fake accounts and paying **₹799 or more** for a subscription that does not deliver what it promises.

What This Means for TM Café

- ⊗ The 263 helpful votes on the payroll review is not one frustrated user — it is a widely shared experience. TM Café inherits this distrust by default.

Layered paywalls, fake profiles, and surprise charges together produce one user feeling: TrulyMadly is designed to **extract money, not deliver value**. This directly poisons every TM Café payment CTA.

"Scam, Fraud, Money hungry... charged ₹600 without my permission."

— Play Store review, Feb 2026

"Even with top subscription, swipes are 10–15. Messages cost extra. Spark costs extra."

— Play Store review (263 helpful votes)

Why Does Astrotalk Convert but TrulyMadly Does Not?

Every friend interviewed has paid Astrotalk. None felt cheated. The reason is consistent: Astrotalk gives **2 minutes free first**.

Dimension	TrulyMadly Today	Astrotalk	What TM Café Should Do
Entry Model	₹799 upfront paywall	2 minutes free first	2 minutes free with every expert
User Feeling at Entry	Risk and anxiety	Low commitment, curious	Remove the risk entirely
After Payment	Fake profiles, no value	Real conversation, real answer	Expert warmth in first 60 seconds
Repeat Rate	Under 2% of MAU	25–30% return	Target: 40%+ return in 14 days

"Astrotalk gave me 2 minutes free. I felt the value in those 2 minutes. After that, paying ₹500 felt completely normal." — User interview, 24 years, Bengaluru

The 10–15 Minute Emotional Window

A 25-year-old gets ghosted at 11pm. He is embarrassed to call friends. What does he do?

Most likely — he closes the app and opens Instagram. **He probably does not even know TM Café exists.** The window where TM Café could have helped him is **about 10–15 minutes wide.**

Trigger Moment	How the User Feels	Without TM Café	With a Moment-Match Nudge
Ghosted after a week of chatting	Confused, embarrassed, alone	Closes app, opens Instagram	Taps nudge, lands on Café home
5 failed swipes in one sitting	Self-doubt, frustration	Keeps swiping or quits	Bottom sheet: "Feeling low? Talk to someone"
11pm Sunday, no matches this week	Lonely, empty	Watches reels, goes to sleep	Push: "Talk to someone tonight — first 2 mins free"
Bad date, no second date planned	Disappointed, overthinking	Vents to a friend	"How did your date go?" prompt in-app

Four Emotional State Personas

These personas are defined by **what the user just experienced** — not by age or city. The same 25-year-old in Mumbai can be a Pre-Date Prepper on Thursday and a Ghosted Overthinker on Saturday.



The Ghosted Overthinker

Highest urgency & willingness to pay (up to ₹600). Needs a Listener first. Target with post-unmatch nudge within 10 minutes.



The Relationship Overthinker

Age 25–32. Over-analyses everything. Returns 3–5x/month. Pays ₹300–500/session. Highest revenue persona — most likely to subscribe.



The Chronic Lonely

Persistent low-intensity emotional gap — peaks on Sunday evenings and festivals. Highest long-term LTV if subscription habit forms.



The Pre-Date Prepper

Has a first date coming up. Pays ₹200–350. Easiest to A/B test. Best reached right after setting a date inside the app.

The Trigger-to-Payment Funnel Today

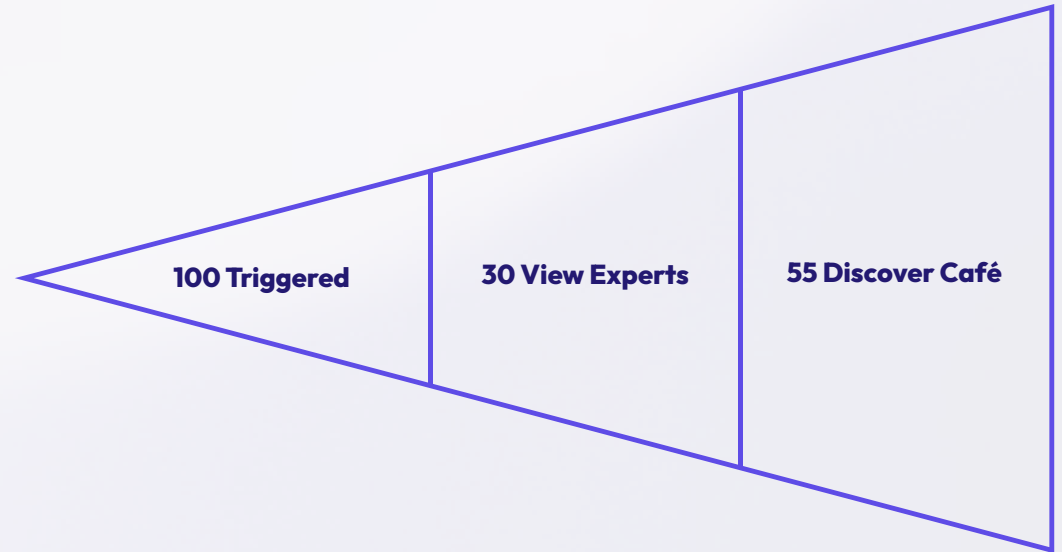
The Core Gap

Out of every **100 users** who experience an emotional trigger, only **5 end up making a paid Café call today**.

The two biggest drop-offs:

1. **Discovery** — Café tab is buried 3–4 clicks deep
2. **Payment** — no free trial to build trust first

- ✅ Fix just these two things — a moment-match nudge after rejection and a 2-minute free trial — and conversion can move from **5% to 12–15%**.



That is the entire TM Café strategy in one funnel.

Pricing Insights: The Sequence Matters More Than the Price

 A user who happily pays ₹500 on Astrotalk will refuse to pay ₹199 on TrulyMadly — not because of the price, but because of the trust gap.

Segment	Max WTP	Sweet Spot	Walk-Away Price	Key Note
Ghosted Overthinker	₹600	₹300–400	Above ₹700	High urgency drives higher WTP
Chronic Lonely	₹400	₹199–299	Above ₹500	Needs to feel cheap — habit over urgency
Pre-Date Prepper	₹400	₹200–350	Above ₹500	Clear ROI framing helps conversion
Relationship Overthinker	₹600	₹300–500	Above ₹700	Repeat buyer — highest LTV
Arranged-Marriage Confused	₹500	₹250–400	Above ₹600	Bilingual session justifies premium
Tier 2/3 General User	₹200	₹99–149	Above ₹250	PPP pricing essential — Hindi sessions

Key Takeaway: The price is not the problem. The sequence is. **Value must come before payment.** Once a user has felt something real in a free 2-minute trial, they will pay — and they will come back.

Expert Quality, Economics & Retention Risk

Expert Overview

Type	Count	Avg Rating	Est. Earnings/ Month	Churn Risk
Coach	~40	4.6	₹8,000–20,000	Medium
Listener	~25	4.5	₹3,000–8,000	High
Astrologer	~20	4.7	₹5,000–12,000	Low

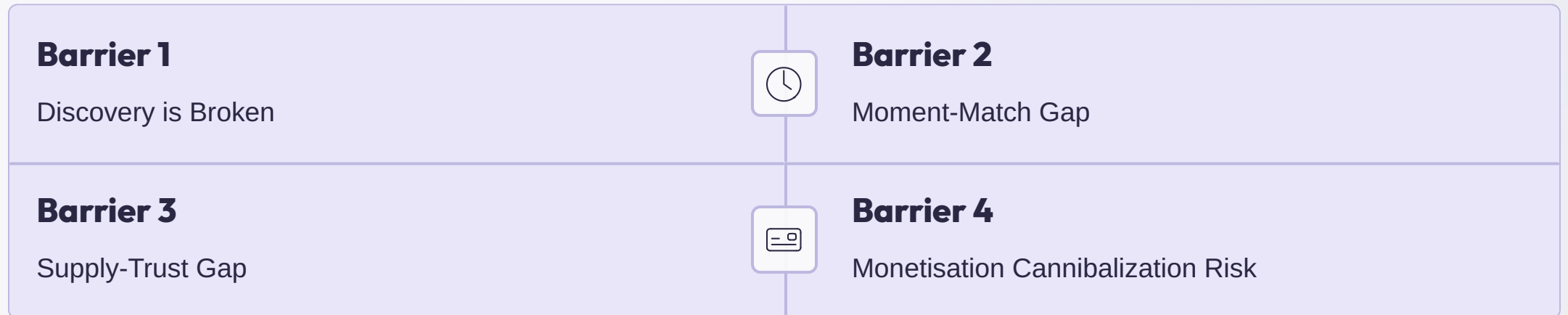
⊗ The Listener category is the most at-risk. They carry the highest emotional load, earn the least, and have the highest churn rate. If Listeners leave, TM Café loses its most important entry point for new users.

What Drives a 4.5+ Rating

- **Warm Opening**
Expert greets the user personally in the first 60 seconds — not a script
- **Active Listening**
Reflects back what the user says. Indian cultural context included naturally.
- **Language Match**
Speaks in the user's preferred language — Hindi, Telugu, etc.
- **Post-Call Follow-Up**
Sends a check-in message 2–3 days after the session

Four Barriers. One Broken Funnel.

TM Café is a genuinely valuable product sitting inside a platform most Indians have never heard of — and inside that platform it is further buried where users never find it. The problem is not the idea. The problem is **four specific barriers** preventing TM Café from reaching users at the moment they need it.



Breaking Down Each Barrier

Barrier 1 — Discovery (Two Levels)

Outer: TrulyMadly has low brand awareness outside metro cities.

Inner: Even among installed users, Café is buried 3–4 clicks deep with no nudge. A user can open TrulyMadly daily for months and never know Café exists.

Fix: Moment-match nudge immediately after rejection, unmatched, or ghosting — before the user exits the app.

Barrier 2 — The Moment-Match Gap

The window between an emotional trigger and a user being open to help is **approximately 10–15 minutes**. After that, they scroll reels or go to sleep. TrulyMadly currently does nothing in that window.

Fix: Detect unmatched, 5 failed swipes, Sunday 9pm — and surface a Café nudge immediately.

Barrier 3 — Supply-Trust & First-Call Anxiety

Current expert listing shows names and ratings but no specialisations. A user who just got ghosted does not know if they need a Coach or a Listener. Cultural stigma around opening up to a stranger — especially among young men — is real.

Fix: Specialisation tags on every expert bio + 2 minutes free + warm opening in first 60 seconds.

Barrier 4 — Cannibalization Risk

Select/VIP subscriptions (₹799) are about getting more matches. TM Café is about handling the emotional side of dating. These are complementary, not competing — but only if Café is triggered exclusively from emotional moments.

Fix: Trigger Café only post-rejection, post-unmatched, post-bad date. Never as a substitute for dating features.

RICE Prioritisation — Top Solutions

15 solutions were evaluated across the four barriers. Scored using **Reach × Impact × Confidence ÷ Effort**.

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE Score
First 2 mins free with every expert	50,000	4	1.0	1	200,000
Moment-Match Entry System with AI Concierge & Gamification	30,000	4	0.8	3	32,000
Sunday 9pm push notification	10,000	2	0.8	0.5	32,000
Verified expert badges	8,000	2	1.0	0.5	32,000
Tier 2/3 PPP pricing ₹99	12,000	3	0.8	1	28,800
Day 3 & Day 7 check-in	5,000	3	0.8	1	12,000
Post-ghosting nudge (48h)	7,000	3	0.8	1.5	11,200
Café tile in swipe feed	6,000	2	0.8	1	9,600

Two Solutions. One Complete Funnel.

Solution 1 — First 2 Minutes Free

- Directly removes the biggest barrier: hesitation to pay without experiencing value
- Proven model — high confidence (Astrotalk benchmark)
- Fast to implement — Effort score: 1
- RICE Score: 200,000 — highest by far

Directly increases paying users.

Solution 2 — Moment-Match Entry System with AI Concierge & Gamification

- Detects emotional triggers (ghosting, rejection, inactivity) in real time
- AI concierge routes users to right expert — reduces guidance confusion
- Gamification builds streaks, check-ins, personalization for repeat engagement

Together these two create a **complete funnel**:

1

Entry

Moment-match nudges

2

Conversion

Free trial

3

Retention

AI + Gamification

6-Month Product Roadmap

Month	Phase	Focus	Key Features	Target Paying Users	Success Metric
1	Power User Cohort	Foundation	First 2 mins free · Post-rejection & post-unmatch nudge	7,500	15% complete first Café call
2	Power User Cohort	Activation	Post-ghosting nudge · Sunday 9pm push · Verified expert badges	10,000	Nudge CTR 15% · Free-to-paid 40%
3	Tier 1 City Rollout	Conversion	AI Concierge live · Specialisation tags · Day 3 & Day 7 check-ins	25,000	Free trial completion 80% · Avg rating 4.6
4	Tier 1 City Rollout	Retention	Gamification streaks · Post-call check-in · Café tile in swipe/feed	35,000	D14 repeat rate 40% · Wallet recharge 2x
5	Tier 2/3 Rollout	Scale	Hindi sessions · ₹99 flat pricing · UPI one-tap · Festival campaigns	55,000	8% of Tier 2/3 cohort converts
6	Full MAU	Growth	LGBTQ-safe listeners · Advanced AI personalisation · Refer-a-friend	75,000	15% of MAU paying · Café = 30% of revenue

The 7-Stage User Journey

The prototype demonstrates a complete **trust-first experience** — the user never sees a payment screen before feeling genuine value.

Every screen in the journey is designed around one research insight: **Indian users will pay for emotional support if the first experience removes risk and feels warm.** The gamification layer ensures that first experience becomes a habit — which is what moves revenue share from 5% to 30% over 12 months.



How Trust is Built at Every Screen



Moment-Match Nudge

Triggered by unmatched (within 30 sec), 5 failed swipes, or 48h chat inactivity. Copy is signal-specific: ghosting gets *"That didn't go well, right?"* — not a generic prompt.



AI Smart Concierge

Opens with warmth — "Hey, I'm here to listen. What happened?" User picks from: Got ghosted / Bad date / Feeling lonely / Nervous to text. AI routes to the right expert type with context pre-filled.



Free Trial with Live Timer

A visible countdown: "Free time left: 1:42." After 2 minutes a gentle prompt — "Want to keep going? Continue at ₹14/min." Users who felt value continue; others leave without feeling cheated.

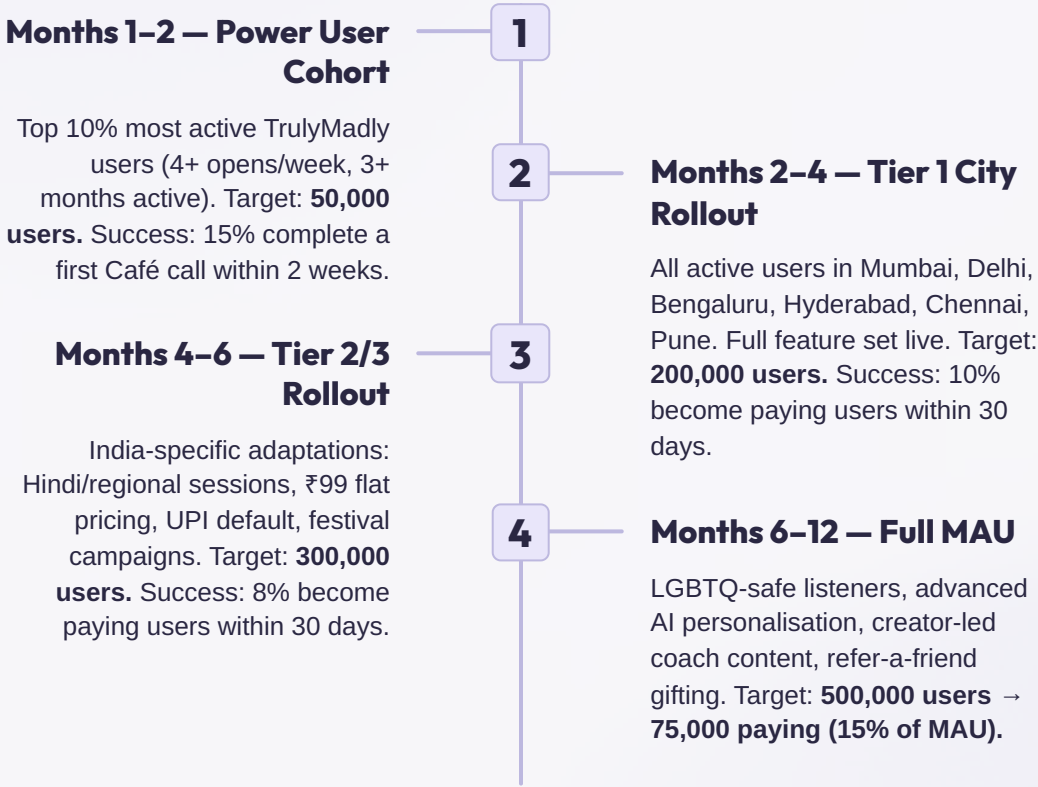


Gamification & Streak Dashboard

Shows current streak, emotional progress, sessions done, Café points. A 5-day streak unlocks 5 free minutes — creating a daily habit loop before the emotional memory of the first session fades.

Prototype links: [New TM Café experience \(7 screens\)](#) · [Existing TrulyMadly before state](#)

India GTM — Phased Rollout



Revenue Projections

Metric	Value
Avg wallet top-up	₹399
Recharges/user/month	1.5
Monthly wallet revenue/paying user	₹599
Paying users (15% of 500K MAU)	75,000
Monthly wallet revenue	₹4.49 Cr
Annual wallet revenue	₹53.9 Cr

Take Rate Economics

TM Café takes **30%** of every session; expert earns **70%**.

At scale (75,000 paying users × 3 sessions/month × ₹300 avg):

Monthly GMV = **₹6.75 Cr**

TM revenue (30%) = **₹2.02 Cr/month**

Annual TM Café revenue = **₹24.3 Cr**

✔ Combined with wallet recharge revenue: **₹78 Cr annually** — approaching ₹100 Cr target within 18 months.

Three Growth Loops + The Monetisation Flywheel

Three Growth Loops

Loop 1 — Word of Mouth Through Outcomes

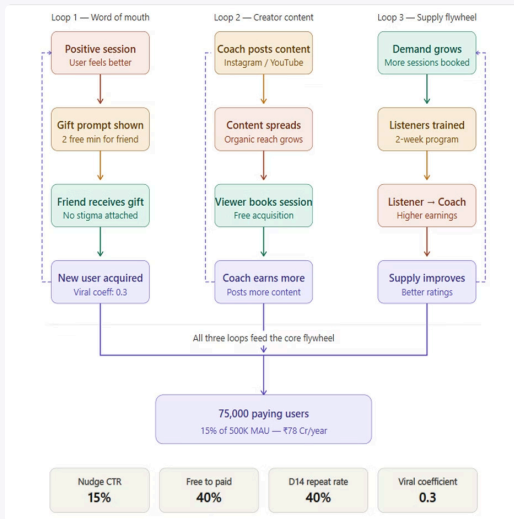
Post positive check-in → "Gift your friend 2 free minutes." Sharing feels like gifting, not confessing. Viral coefficient target: 0.3

Loop 2 — Creator-Led Content from Coaches

Coaches post dating advice on Instagram/YouTube with a session booking link. Coach builds personal brand; TM Café gets free acquisition.

Loop 3 — Listener → Coach Supply Flywheel

High-performing Listeners offered Coach training. Supply pipeline grows with demand. Expert retention improves as earnings grow.



Monetisation Flywheel (5 Stages)



Free Dating User

Opens TrulyMadly to swipe and match

Emotional Trigger

Rejection, ghosting, loneliness — nudge appears

First Paid Call

AI routes to expert → 2 mins free → wallet recharged ₹199

Habit Forms

Day 3 & Day 7 check-ins → streak → wallet recharged ₹399

Session Pack

5 sessions for ₹1,499 — higher LTV, stronger habit

North Star Metric

15% of MAU

% of Monthly Active Users who are paying Café users — target within 12 months (from under 2% today)

At 500,000 current MAU, 15% = **75,000 paying users per month**. This metric was chosen because it scales with the app, cannot be gamed by overall growth, and directly reflects whether TM Café is delivering genuine value at the right moment.

75%

Trigger-to-Nudge Rate

Target: 75% of triggered users see the moment-match nudge (from 45% today)

40%

Free-to-Paid Conversion

Target: 40% of free trial users continue to a paid session (from 20% today)

40%

D14 Repeat Rate

Target: 40% of first-call users book a second session within 14 days (from 20% today)

4.6

Expert Quality Score

Target: average expert rating of 4.6 across all sessions (from 4.3 today)

Initiative Metrics, Guardrails & Event Tracking

Guardrail Metrics — Warning Signals

Guardrail	Threshold	Action if Breached
Subscription cannibalization	10–15% of Select/VIP users reduce spend	Pause Café cross-sell, investigate overlap
Expert quality drop	Avg rating below 4.3	Suspend low-rated experts, trigger retraining
Expert burnout rate	Above 20% reducing availability	Cap session hours, review pay rates
User wellbeing flag	Above 5% feel worse post-call	Audit expert sessions, review recordings
First-call refund rate	Above 8%	Review expert quality, audit AI routing

Top 5 Event Tracking Events

01	trigger_moment_detected App detects unmatched swipe, failure, or ghosting — captures trigger_type
02	nudge_tapped User taps the nudge CTA — captures time_since_trigger and copy_variant
03	free_trial_started & completed User starts and completes 2-minute free trial — captures expert_id and duration
04	payment_completed UPI/wallet payment confirmed — captures amount, method, expert_id
05	second_session_booked User books repeat session within 14 days — captures days_since_first_call

Key Risks with Mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Misuse for escort-type services	Medium	Very High	Clear community guidelines, AI moderation, instant report button, 24-hour human review, zero-tolerance suspension
Expert burnout from free trial sessions	High	High	Cap free trial sessions per expert at 10/day; pay experts for free trial minutes at reduced rate
Supply-side quality drop at scale	High	High	Minimum 10-session trial before going live; mandatory retraining if rating drops below 4.3
Subscription cannibalization of Select/VIP	Medium	High	Position Café only at emotional trigger moments; monitor cannibalization rate weekly against 10–15% threshold
Astrotalk moving into dating advice	Medium	High	Exclusive expert contracts; deepen TrulyMadly context advantage — Café knows what just happened to the user
Regulatory risk (telehealth/counselling)	Low	Very High	Position experts as coaches/listeners, not therapists. Add disclaimer on every session: "This is not therapy."
Free rider exploitation of free trial	High	Medium	Limit free trial to one per expert per user account — not one per day

⊗ The most important risk to address **before launch** is the misuse risk. A single incident going viral would permanently damage TM Café's brand on a dating platform.

Five Trade-offs and Their Rationale

1 Freemium Generosity vs Conversion Pressure

Chose freemium over full paywall — Astrotalk's model proves it works at scale in India. Free rider risk is managed by limiting trial to one per expert per account. Decision reviewed at Month 6 with actual data.

2 Dating Focus vs Loneliness Economy Expansion

Chose expansion — Astrotalk's ₹1,600 Cr ARR proves Indian users will pay. TrulyMadly has a unique context advantage: it knows exactly what emotional moment the user just experienced.

3 Per-Minute Pricing vs Flat Session Pricing

Chose flat session as default — per-minute feels like a taxi meter; users watch the clock and cannot relax. Free trial removes the upfront commitment anxiety for flat pricing.

4 High-Empathy Listeners vs Domain-Expert Coaches

Resolved through AI routing: post-breakup users get Listeners; pre-date preppers get Coaches. Invest more in Listener pay rates to reduce churn even if it compresses short-term margins.

5 Tier 1 Premium Pricing vs Tier 2/3 PPP Pricing

Chose PPP pricing — 54% of new TrulyMadly users come from Tier 2/3 cities. Differentiation is based on detected city, not user choice — standard practice in Indian SaaS.

AI-Powered Concierge & Automation System

What the System Does



Emotional Trigger Detection

Detects ghosting, rejection, or inactivity in real time



Intent Classification

Identifies issue type: ghosting / breakup / loneliness / dating advice



AI Expert Routing

Recommends the most relevant expert category



Personalised Follow-Ups

Day 3 & Day 7 contextual nudges to improve retention

Example Flow



8 Prompts Powering the AI Concierge

1

Emotion Detection

Detect tone: sad, anxious, confused, angry, or neutral

2

Intent Classification

Classify issue: ghosting, breakup, loneliness, dating advice, confidence, emotional support

3

Empathetic Response

Generate a short empathetic acknowledgement of the user's emotional state

4

Expert Mapping

Recommend the most relevant expert category based on classified issue

5

Expert Ranking

Rank top 3 experts by specialisation, rating, and session quality

6

Safety Moderation

Detect inappropriate or escort-related intent and flag for human review

7

Personalised Follow-Up

Generate Day 3 or Day 7 nudge based on previous emotional trigger

8

Retention Prediction

Predict likelihood of return session based on outcome and post-call feedback

CONCLUSION

TM Café — The Complete Strategic Picture

TM Café is sitting on top of a real and growing market. India's loneliness economy is worth over **₹1,600 Cr annually**. TrulyMadly has **12 million users** who experience the exact emotional moments TM Café is designed for.

The Problem

4 barriers: buried discovery, missed emotional window, broken trust, and no free trial

The Solution

Moment-match nudges + 2 minutes free + AI concierge + gamification loops

The Rollout

Power users → Tier 1 cities → Tier 2/3 at ₹99 → full MAU in 6 months

The Revenue

75,000 paying users → ₹78 Cr annually → approaching ₹100 Cr in 18 months

None of these fixes require rebuilding TrulyMadly from scratch. They require **smart product decisions layered on top of what already exists** — showing up at the right moment, removing the payment barrier, and delivering real value in the first 2 minutes.

